Despatch No. 5
Telegram from Mr. Parkes



No 6. Shanghai, August 28th 1870.

Your Excellency:

In reply to a communication in Japanese, dated August 21st, from Mr Okubo, I have had the honor to address a despatch to His Excellency, of which enclosure No 1 is a copy.

In connection with Mr Okubo's mission I have very little to say, except that it is to be regretted that the "Stonewall" was not sent to Amoy, as the hands of the high Commissioner would have been much strengthened thereby. The news of the reported loss of

this ironclad has caused considerable excitement in Shanghai among the native authorities, their attitude suddenly becoming exceedingly warlike. Numerous contracts for war material, among which two ironclads are spoken of, continue to be made, and foreigners are daily being hired to recruit and organize troops. Inspector-General Hart has offered fifty taels per month additional salary to every tide-waiter in the Customs Service who will take temporary service with the Chinese Generals in drilling the troops.

But although these preparations evidence the intention of the Chinese Government to declare war against Japan, they should not be understood as being indicative



of any additional strength on the part of China to conduct the war after it has been declared. The Chinese buy everything and anything that is offered to them; and by and by they will have, beside a large quantity of unserviceable arms, such a variety of serviceable ones that, when the time comes to use them, they will prove of no avail in the hands of the soldiers, because of the confusion that must ensue in dealing out ammunition, the cartridges intended for one arm being substituted for those provided for another, with which it cannot be used; and ultimately, the soldiers, disgusted with their weapons, in the use

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of which they will not have been properly drilled, and despairing of the cause of a government by whose improvidence and neglect they are thus made to suffer, will become thoroughly demoralized, and will desert.

Already the people are showing great want of confidence in their rulers. Not only do the soldiers refuse to enlist, but, after enlisting, they refuse to leave China as soon as they are told that their destination is Formosa. There is a large Chinese frigate at Nagasaki, which was in full commission when I arrived. The other day she was ordered to proceed to Formosa; but on the day before she was to sail, the whole crew deserted excepting thirty — and



yesterday only three remained on board. A few days ago the Nagasaki Shimbun went to Shanghai to get troops. Yesterday she returned with none. The government of China has but few friends among either the natives or the foreigners; and those who abstain from showing their hostility to it, are only those who can make money by supplying arms for it. The day she meets with any reverse will see her with no friends left. She will be deserted by all.

Besides this, there are signs of revolt in every direction and it is rumored that the leaders only wait for the announcement of a declaration of war against Japan to raise their flag. All

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these things are known to the Government of China, and I hope that, when the time comes for them to decide with Mr. Okubo whether it shall be war or peace between the two countries, wisdom will prevail in their councils. This is the golden moment for Mr. Okubo to seize in negociating with them. It is a peculiarity of human nature that, even after much deliberation and while yet the prey to much excitement, when we come to the moment when we have to take a resolution on which our destiny may depend, we hesitate and are most apt to be influenced by sound views.

The partisans of war have not been idle in causing the greatest excitement among the people in order to gain them to their cause.



A most virulent article appeared the other day in the 'Hiogo Nao' to which I have thought well to make a reply. To this effect, the pamphlet, copies of which I enclose, was written and published by me, without any one knowing from whom it originated. The cause of the opposition to the Formosa expedition lying chiefly in the ignorance in which the people are of the rights of China, this pamphlet, wherein these rights are dispassionately discussed, cannot but gain, even among the foreign ministers, many friends to Japan. I will have it circulated in Peking if Mr. Okubo so desires.

Inspector General Hart has had a large map of a portion

of the coast and interior of China printed for the use of the War Department at Peking, I have had the opportunity to obtain a tracing of this map, which I beg to enclose to you herewith, together with a printed map of Shanghai and vicinity.

Hoping that my actions thus far will meet with the approval of the Government and of Your Excellency.

I have the honor to be,

Your Excellency's

Most Obedient, humble Servant,

Chs. W. de Leeuw

His Excellency

Okuma Shigenobu,

Minister of Finance,

etc. etc. etc.

Enclosure No 1

Copy Shanghai August 21st 1874.

Your Excellency:

I have the honor to acknowledge the receipt of your letter of to-days date, whereby you inform me that, in compliance with instructions from the Japanese Government, I have to hold myself subject to your orders, and you direct me to proceed to Peking, by way of Chefoo and Tientsin, in about a week from today. I shall take great pleasure in complying with these instructions and beg to subscribe myself

Your Excellency's

Most obedient, humble Servant,

(Signed) Chs Le. de Leeuw

His Excellency Fac-simile.
Okubo Toshimichi
&c. &c. &c. High Commissioner
and Plenipotentiary.

No 7. Pekin, September 25th 1874.

Your Excellency:

I have the honor to inform you that we arrived at Pekin on the 10th instant, one day in advance of the time I had specified; and therefore no quarters has yet been prepared for me. Under the circumstances I was glad to accept the hospitality of a Buddhist priest, part of whose temple, the Kow tchung ellow, I rented, and where I am now located, with Mr. Daido and Mr. Ogima, holding myself subject to the orders of the High Commissioner.

I have the honor to be,

Your

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